Allies of Convenience

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Catra (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra)

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by dzmatron

Summary

Catra is hard at work laying her traps;but a potential threat from the Empire spurs her to action.

Lonnie is sent on a mission to find out about this new threat. But as the old adage implies - no plan survives first contact with the enemy.

This one is the first "multi-chapter" story in SPACE CAPTAIN CATRA - I hope you enjoy. Ill aim to have the next bit up soon!

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Best laid plans

Catra perched on the edge of the desk, practically in a squat on top of it. Her Captain's cape draped across her shoulders as she squinted down at Entrapta, who was busy working at the terminal next to her. With a squeal of triumph, the diminutive techie flung up her arms and rolled back on her chair. Catra flinched and let out an involuntary hiss, but settled back down, her fur flattening after her initial surprise. She cleared her throat and managed:

"So?"

"SO! I AM IN!" Entrapta practically cackled.

Catra grinned broadly and sagged, "Thank *fuck*. Two weeks setting up freakin' sensors across this forsaken system wasn't a waste of time."

"Oh! Is it working?" Catra's head popped her head around the door to the tech room, "AH! Wildcat, before I forget - we got the generators in the sublevels fully functional. Rogelio has the wrench guys clearing out the rubble from the labs. Looks like something really tore through this place."

Catra grinned at Scorpia, "Good job. Honestly, I'm surprised this place is still standing. Considering the storms on the surface."

"Well, it's not Alacran, but it's nice to be planetside for a bit! Also, less recycled air," mused the big hybrid. Her stinger tail twitched slightly and her nose wrinkled and Catra huffed in agreement.

"You think you've got it bad, shipboard with *my* sense of smell? Yeah."

"Huh, I never considered that," mused Entrapta, "Do I need to do some maintenance on the filtration systems on the Destroyer?"

The diminutive techie tapped her lips, lost in thought, so Catra didnt bother replying. She glanced about the room for a moment then huffed. It wasnt great but it was good enough as a stable home base.

Since gaining Hordak's support and her takeover of Octavia's fleet, her fortunes had changed. Shed known that hightailing it into the belt to flush out Adora and her freaky shuttle would have been madness. So, shed come up with a plan. Their initial survey had turned up this little research base, abandoned of course. So, shed decided they needed a more secure location. Running a hunt op from a flotilla was doable but brought up its own issues - namely around rendezvous points, rallying the fleet and the risk of splitting them up.

Having a secure homebase on a planetoid made things, weirdly, more secure. Yes it was static - but it was also mostly subterranean and hard to spot - anyone trying to find the damn place without prior knowledge would have to scan a WHOLE planet - not something that was exactly a quick action. Also, it meant they could more easily secure their supplies and offload the ships in the flotilla, meaning there was now less risk if they lost a ship - they wouldnt lose the stored supplies.

It also meant that they could "offshore" some of their intelligence gathering to a defensible, hidden location. The people in the system would be looking for ships and thus, if they had the ability, would target them. And, finally, it meant that the fleet could run operations elsewhere, while the base ran its *own* little runs.

Of course, resupplying to and from the base had to be done carefully, but Horde operations mandated several layers of security around supply drops - especially around planetary insertions in less secure systems. The Horde wasnt so arrogant to assume it ALWAYS had the upper hand.

The next part of Catra's plan had been that aforementioned *intelligence* aspect - shed had the frigates split off to spread around

the system periphery - to a casual observer, they'd look like the usual Horde patrols. Staying at the fringes, not wanting to "get involved" in a nuisance system. Catra reckoned Adora would buy that, considering she knew how impulsive and reactionary Catra had been in the past - she wouldn't expect her to hold back and be *subtle*. Of course, those patrols had had *another* purpose - to spread her little web wider.

The thought brought a smile to Catra's face, "Should've finished the job," she murmured to herself. But the words didn't bring satisfaction - just a pang of regret. Catra adjusted on her perch and huffed again, then looked at the jury rigged setup that Entrapta had constructed. A series of monitors and salvaged computer parts, connected with various spares from the fleet in orbit above.

That was a *slight* risk - leaving the ships. She was a bit worried about a mutiny against *her* mutiny. Except Lonnie was in command on the bridge of the Destroyer, which gave her some semblance of reassurance (if only because Rogelio was on the planet and Lonnie wouldn't put *him* at risk.)

"So, we've got the sensor net all set up?" Catra queried. Entrapta nodded and flicked a key on the panel in her lap. One of the screens lit up, showing a wireframe of the system.

"Yes! The red dots are our buoys, the green ones existing comm buoys that we've managed to infiltrate."

They'd had the frigates deploy the buoys in various spots, then allowed the system's gravity (Plus the buoy's own on board thrusters) to align them across the system to act as sensor nets. A small flight of fighters had even gone into the belt to anchor several into the debris, their smaller size making them harder to spot - and it was a lot safer than risking another larger hull in that debris field *and* against the risk of running into Adora and her crazy weird ship again. Catra doubted that there was much in the way of a system wide militarised presence here, certainly not one with the resources to monitor EVERY part of the system, but she wasn't taking chances.

After all, Adora had wrecked the *Shadow* with what was SUPPOSED to be a damn tug boat. Who knew what else this freaky system had in store. There was a destroyed planet and signs of Horde presence, long-since abandoned. Something had gone down here. She just wondered what Adora had to do with it.

"Probably just lucky . Stumbled on some shit and got greedy," growled Catra.

"What was that Wildcat?" Scorpia cocked her head and frowned. The magicat waved her away.

"Nothin'. So, T rapta, what's the sitch?"

The techie frowned at the screen then traced a few lines with her gloved fingers, "So, got transponder hits, IFF hits..now we're in their net we can *mask* our ships more easily than just using our normal silent running techniques. It does mean letting W eaver a little bit off the leash buuuut I can still keep her mostly shackled."

Catra bit her lip and nodded, "Fine. D we want to move her down here?"

"Eh, may be better to allow her limited access here. I dont think removing an AI core from the ship is a good idea. Might leave too many things to chance *and* she may be able to leave some surprises for us. Better keep her hooked up through avenues we control."

"Alright, you're the expert." Catra sat back on the desk, then hugged one knee to her chest, the other draped over the edge. Her tail lashed out from beneath her cloak, "SO, what are we looking at? Movements? T roops? Fleet sizes?"

Entrapta blinked and shook her head, "Um..not a lot. There' s a sensor shadow that covers a good..quarter of the belt. Best guess there's probably a port or maybe a series of ports hidden in there. Likely you need more than just transponders or comm codes - you'd

need to be given access. I think they'll be running some sort of encryption routine to guide you to the location."

"Can you crack it?"

"Not if it's randomised daily. Even with a code you'd need to know which code they chose to use or request access from probably sentry locations. And I doubt they'd give a Horde frigate entry codes." Entrapta quirked a manic grin at her Captain.

Catra snorted and shook her head, "So, we need a way of tracking them back to base. That may be where Adora's hiding. Any sign of her?"

"Ummm..well, I am tracking a few mining ships. A few keep switching transponder codes, but I think that's to hide from, well, *us* . Or pirates. Got a larger cruiser out there..think it's pirate, plus a few.. Hmmm..there's an asteroid base or two, plus some refueling spots, but those are listed as derel- oooh."

"What?" Catra leaned forwards.

"Interesting. Some video logs going over the net. Warning of..". Entrapta frowned then looked at Catra, "A Praetorian?"

The magicat stared at her, then at Scorpia, "Get that vid. Now."

Fifteen minutes later the trio stood, shocked, staring at the monitor. They'd watched the vid several times now - it was a collection of grainy images, clearly salvaged from a more complete set. Flashes of plasma fire, blurry shots of pirates trying to fix on a target they couldn't see. The perspective shifted repeatedly, only glimpses of a shadow as it moved and murdered through a rock-lined complex.

The final shot was an off angled image, the only clear shot of the suspected Praetorian as it strangled the pirate leader with his own weapon. Then the vid froze.

Catra swallowed but it was Scopria who spoke up, "Why would the Empire have a *Praetorian* out here?"

The question clicked against something in Catra's mind, "They're after what we're after."

Entrapta and Scorpia looked at her and the techie asked, "What do you mean?"

"The Empire knows what's out here, somehow. Maybe Weaver alerted someone, maybe Hordak flagged it up the chain. Either way, we've got competition. And a Praetorian means Horde intelligence. We need to move fast. Is that all that's on the file?"

"Uhhh yeah. I can't salvage what isn't there. If we had access to the source data...but I can't get into the systems on that base. Not without a hardwired link."

Catra nodded as something froze in her chest. If the Empire had a Praetorian out here, that meant they were going to find Adora. And if they found Adora then...well, *Catra* had wanted to capture her.

And then what? Came her treacherous thoughts. Catra bit her lip.

If I found her, I could take the tech and then Adora could just disappear again. But if the Praetorian gets her, she'll… she'll.... They'll tear her apart for information.

Catra felt genuine fear in her gut. Not for herself, but for a girl she'd watched whipped. At the time she'd felt a mixture of savage satisfaction combined with an almost unbearable guilt. Or so she'd told herself - that satisfaction was something she'd clung to, desperately, to try to mask her feelings as a girl she'd valued more than life itself had taken the beating, near wordlessly until that eight flash of the whip.

And that had been the last time Catra had seen Adora, until their confrontation in the belt.

The Captain headed for the door and Scorpia followed her, "Entrapta, keep working on getting the net set up. Im heading back to the ship. Scorpia, stay here, get things set up."

"What are you gonna do?" asked Scorpia.

"Send out the hunting dogs."

The light of the system's sun broke gently over the disc of the large gas giant and revealed the outline of the distant refueling base. Lights twinkled against its surface as numerous craft of various sizes moved around the exterior .

"Abandoned my ass," growled Lonnie as she adjusted the vector of her interceptor. She thumbed her comm switch, which beamed a tight-band laser link to the other four craft on her wing, "Stay tight everyone - looks like the kitty was right to warn us of activity."

Catra had given her a very basic task - reconnoitre the site, board and get the hard drives - or at least get a hard link attached. She had stated that there might be scavengers, that the Transponder signals across the system showed *some* activity - but this was a step above. Likely as not, most of the vessels around the station were maintenance craft, so wouldnt exactly show up on anything beyond local scans, if that.

Lonnie sighed - military intelligence, an oxymoron if ever there was one. But Catra had at least told her to *be careful* .

They were using the manned craft - drone signals got too screwy and laggy far from the controller ship, too vulnerable to counter hacks. So, they were using the stealthier model of interceptors that most Destroyers kept on hand for longer range patrols or fire

support. Each interceptor had its own small complement of spherical drones, in case things got dicey, but they were mainly to allow for the nippy fighter craft to evade and counter attack. Interceptors could hit hard, but were a little more fragile, as they had to carry life support elements, plus couldnt pull the same sort of g-moves a drone could.

Their small squadron cut engines and angled for a slow approach. Lonnie kept her passive sensors on, along with her normal mark-one eyeball. Her HUD had a magnifier and she used it to map out potential defences - which were pathetic. A couple of turrets on the station and maybe one patrolling shuttle craft. The way it drifted, the pilot seemed to be going through the motions.

‘And these assholes kicked our asses?’ grumbled the pilot. She adjusted herself in the flight seat and angled the nose of her craft. The other fighters mirrored the move and followed her in. They were painted matt-black and had ID markings masked; their heat signatures were low and they had no active pings. They were designed in such a way that RADAR and laser sensors would have a harder time pinpointing them - a sensor operator would have to be watching for them to recognise their faint blips.

Slowly they ghosted closer - in the vacuum of space there was no noise to announce them and some one would have to be looking out a porthole to spot the shape of their craft. Their vector kept them against the inky black, so they were pretty invisible.

Lonnie kept them on the opposing side to the main hangar, to the side that was mostly rock. The station appeared to be built into a couple of drifting asteroids - barely an asteroid by anyone’s measure, let alone a moon.

She watched as one of her wing-men settled their craft closer to the surface of the station. There was a hiss as the cockpit opened, the sound unheard in the voice, only noticeable for the small amount of atmosphere released into the vacuum. The pilot emerged and jetted to the station’s rocky surface. Loonie watched the man anchor himself then wave. They were going to have to work quickly - IDa

hardpoint or transmitter. No way in hell were they going to be able to get *inside* the station - too many unknowns.

She scanned the space around them, eyes narrowed, while her comrade worked. The other fighters had angled themselves to watch their flanks, like some black flower exploding from the side of the station.

Her comm clicked as the soldier on the surface connected to her. Lonnie tsk'd, "Say again, over."

"Link established. Got a line into a transmitter here. Not the main one, but part of their local communications array. Reckon the techs can remote hop into any live systems. Best we can do short of getting inside or trying to risk a tap on their main transmitter tower. Over"

"Too risky. Return to craft, let's bug out. Over."

"Roger…. Wait. Huh."

"What? Don't break protocol."

" *Sorry ma'am… uh, there's… there's local chatter coming through. Some visitor from the local cell? Bringing supplies to the station… sounds kinda important?"*

Lonnie bit her lip and frowned, "So?"

"Sounds like their security is getting excited. Picket crafts are getting ready to deploy."

That was bad news - more security. But also a potential *bigwig* from the local resistance? That could be a prime target of opportunity.

As if on cue, a flash drew her eye upward - a small cargo craft had emerged from a jump and was angling towards the station. Lonnie keyed her sensors to ping the local net for an IFF signal and frowned at the strange, contradictory data - clearly using smugglers codes.

“ *Yeah that’s her. Bringing supplies in and supervising the refit, apparently, if these orders are anything to go by…”*

“Ok, get in your ship, keep the feed going.we need to bug out *now* .”

And then, like all plans, it went absolutely to *shit* .

A floodlight illuminated the grouped craft and Lonnie twisted in her chair to what looked like a gunship angling their way, with three more craft circling the rim of station at attack speed. Her comm crackled.

“WHAT HO FOUL VILLAINS! Time to meet your maker! ADVENTURE!”

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

Space COMBAT!

A stage is set for THRILLING ADVENTURES (Seahawk not included)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Things went hot exceedingly quickly. Lonnie didn't need to even give an order - as soon as she gunned her engines, the rest of her flight wing exploded into action, their sleek black shapes moving and exploding away like the blossoming of a black flower.

The enemy were just as quick, however; the gunship in position opened up as soon as Lonnie's engines flared to life and slugs of tungsten chewed through the vacuum. One of the fighters was slower off the mark and the rounds stitched their way along its frame. It spun as a thruster blew out and Lonnie heard the pilot's curse cut out as it crashed, soundlessly, against the rocky surface of the station, the silent explosion as its drive core overloaded a flash in the inky void.

"Kilo is down!"

"Copy, break formation, weapons free, head for RV point Delta for extraction, do some damage so they can't pursue, but if you see an

opening *get out* .”

Several mic clicks answered, indicating the flight knew their orders. Lonnie banked hard and kept close to the surface of the station as she rocketed forwards. She was counting on the enemy to not want to risk collateral damage if they missed;a stray round likely to puncture a vulnerable system - back near the transmitter, where the station was rock, those autogun rounds were safe, but as she barrelled towards the metallic superstructures, she knew they'd be trying for guaranteed shots.

Her radar sphere showed the chaos around here as the sentry vessels began their deadly ballet with the Horde fighters.

“In sights, locked, firing.”

“One on my tail, deploying drones.”

“Can’t shake defence fire - station has fuckin’ turrets! Where did they come from!”

Lonnie dove through a pair of struts and spun her craft. She felt the g push her back into her seat, but grit her teeth as her vision blurred. SHe saw the gunship in pursuit.

“ *OH HO! A chase! Have at thee!”*

Tracer fire lanced past her cockpit as a burst erupted from one of the gun pods on the pursuing craft. Lonnie, disengaged her main engine and spun the craft so she was flying *backwards* and opened up with her plasma canons. Bolts of green, superheated plasma flew across the void and made the gunship have to roll in an awkward bank. The bulbous craft tried to reorient to bring a gun pod to bear.

“Fancy! I admire that! Huntara, keep us steady!”

“Just shoot the fucker… I swear… if you hadn’t crashed your last…”

“Not on an open channel!” came the response as another burst raked nearby. Lonnie pulled the nose of her craft around and gunned the engine, shooting off at an angle just moments before her ship would have grazed the surface of the station’s second asteroid. With a flick of her wrist she triggered the dorsal drones on her ship and the spherical bots blasted away from her hull.

The droids spun in the vacuum, then zeroed in on the gunship, spewing laser fire. It scorched the hull and made the larger vessel veer away, to the other side of the rock. Drones weren’t completely deadly, but give them time and they’d slice your hull out from under you.

Lonnie rolled and yanked on the control column to bring her back towards the main fight. She swore as a pair of ships blasted past -

one of her wingmen, pursued by a pair of cargo haulers that looked to have *autocannons* welded to them.

Credit to the rebels, they were resilient, crazy and (she had to admit grudgingly) a little bit badass.

"Missile away!"

Lonnie noted it was Kali, one of her wingmen. She grinned coldly as her computer announced a cluster munition had been launched. *Clear the way* she snarled in her head.

The missile streaked away from one of the black fighters, then exploded into a cone of smaller projectiles. They shot away at random angles, honing in on anything *without* a Horde IFF signal. Small, nasty, no real range - but that wasn't a concern in a combat space this size. Especially where there was a station nearby that *definitely* didn't have one - a lot of distracting collateral damage right there.

Of course, the downside to the cluster munition was that the projectiles didn't try to *avoid* anything either. Not *too* great a problem here, with only a few fighters.

Except, Lonnie realised, she had about five of the micromissiles headed *right at her* .

“Tricky pilot! I have you now!”

...and there was an enemy target right behind her.

Lonnie shrieked in frustration and rolled *hard* . Four of the missiles streaked past, the fifth impacted against a wingtip. The detonation was luckily angled behind her vessel, but it still sent her into a spin. She heard swearing over the open comm and saw the gunship dive away. Two missiles still hit, but the vessel seemed to be made of stern stuff. Micromissiles weren't exactly *shaped* ;good for softer space targets, but a lot of military grade fighters needed more directed charge, or armour piercing capability. Still, it bought her time.

“Ma'am, vip ship is making a hard turn. Think they're spooling engines up to jump out ,”came over her tight-band channel. She checked her target list and, yes, the cargo hauler was making hard burn to cut away from the fight.

Distraction #2 had just presented itself.

“Mox, Kali, on me, drones out. Rest of you, hard burn to the RV. Dump some ordnance onto the station, get their priorities focused.”

“Yes ma'am.”

A rebel craft tumbled by, venting atmosphere and fuel. She watched it bounce off a comm tower;the metal bent and tore away , trailing fragments behind it, as the stricken vessel ruptured and detonated. Two of her wingmen soared past and dumped a trio of missiles towards the base. The rockets impacted against metal structures and panels, sending more debris spiralling. She saw the two turn, then jnk hard. Rounds flashed across the inky black and one of the fighters split in half under the barrage as the enemy gunship and a new craft pushed through the wreckage at speed. Lonnie cursed and angled away. She lined up with the distant Cargo ship and hit the afterburners.

“ *Forming on your wing ma’am, we’re…. OH SHIT!”*

Lonnie’s alarm blared as her sensors flagged a gravity distortion. The shift in spacetime burst behind her and her wingmen’s comm chatter became qietly more panicked.

“Capital ship! Brace! Ali is down, Ali is down!”

Lonnie’s hands flew across her console and she brought up her rear-cameras.

A cruiser sat in space near the station. She could see the blossoming debris cloud and dissipating flames where one of her wingmen - Ali - must've hit the ship as it came out danger-close to the fight.

And the ship was now between her and the fight itself. Lonnie bit her lip and looked to her targeting computer: the cargo hauler had its engines almost fully charged. No way was she going to be able to get by that cruiser without a major detour anyway ....

"All fighters, disengage, max burn! Get the fuck outta here."

There was no response and Lonnie couldn't tell if any of her wing were responding - the damn cruiser was clearly a pirate one, if the fuzziness of her sensors in the area were any indication. She did spot that several fighters were on an intercept vector towards *her* now. Clearly *these* pirates were in some way aligned with the rebels. That or they wanted the cargo hauler as well.

"Horde fighter. Stand down. Your forces are in retreat. Like, don't make me work for this." drawled a voice over the comm channel, "*Wait… what? They got Hawk? Is… how bad? Oh you… Horde fighter craft, power down your engine so I can FUCK YOU UP!"*

Lonnie grimaced as that drawl turned into a terrifying cold monotone.

Well, in for a penny, in for a pound. She directed all energy to her engines and throttled up towards the cargo hauler. Her thumb flicked the cover up on her flight stick and she reached out to flick another switch on her control panel.

“Missiles away , motherfucker.”

She primed the weapon, then depressed the trigger on her flight stick.

The missiles streaked forwards just as the cargo hauler activated its engines. They struck as Lonnie passed over the top of the ship. She wasn't sure what she was trying to achieve, really - old Horde training, really - hurt the enemy, especially if you're going down. Make them pay for every inch.

The cargo ship juddered into its jump and, by sheer happenstance, Lonnie's fighter was in the *right* place. With a jerk, she was yanked along for the ride. She swore as her ship rattled and groaned. Warning lights flashed up one by one and she could see the cargo vessel beginning to shear off hull as it barrelled at very-close-to L speed.

And then, as suddenly as they had started, the cargo vessel flashed - one of its engine nacels turned to slag and the two ships spun into realspace in a deadly tumble. Lonnie squinted as her fighter rotated like a cork in a tide. The star field outside was a blur of white and black, interrupted with the looming horizon of a planetoid.

A scant few hundred metres away, the cargo vessel looked to be in a worse state, a trail of debris behind it, like a mechanical comet. And then Lonnie realised that the ship was coming closer as they hit the

planet's gravity well. She tried reaching forwards, but the g kept her pushed into her seat.

The cargo vessel twisted violently as another engine exploded off. Debris rattled against Lonnie's fighter and she shrieked as she realised the detonation had pushed the freighter closer towards her. She tried to reach for her ejection level, but it felt fruitless.

And then a blast of atmosphere exploded from the side of the freighter and *something* blasted from its flank. The hulk of now-useless metal was pushed an iota off course and Lonnie's tumbling fighter spun past it. Right into whatever had jettisoned.

The object slammed into the side of the fighter with a crunch. Metal shrieked and Lonnie watched with a strange sense of detachment as she saw part of her ship pinwheel away into the void. The ship juddered again and a faint glow suffused the outside. Lonnie realised that the ship had hit the atmosphere of the planetoid. A good thing because a) that meant there *was* an atmosphere (Potential breathing! Also, slowing the ship)

The bad thing was that the ship had *hit atmosphere* in an uncontrolled spin and would likely rip itself apart even before it hit the ground at a ridiculous speed.

With strength and grit born of terrified panic, Lonnie managed to grapple the eject lever. The glow outside vanished and she knew they were in free-fall. The g reduced a little as the atmosphere

provided enough air resistance to slow the spin a little. The added weight of *whatever* was embedded in her fighter also meant a slight slow down.

All her instruments were down - screens blank and unhelpful. She had no idea of the altitude, or if she was about to impact a mountain (just her luck, there'd be a mountain at point of impact)..

So, with nothing to lose, Lonnie yanked the eject lever .

The canopy of the ship exploded away as her whole cockpit blasted free. The force of the exit shredded the remains of the fighter and she watched, dazed, as the whole thing shattered like a glass model, the debris falling below her as the chutes deployed above (The pod detecting an air environment and thus - PARACHUTES!

The next thing that caught Lonnie' s eye was the object that had been blown free.

It too had a parachute.

The pair of pods descended slowly, to land with heavy, awkward thuds against dusty soil. Quick as a flash, Lonnie had her side arm free and kicked open the canopy of the pod. She tumbled out, dazed by the knocks against her flight helmet and the residual effects of the g-forces.

Her eyes took quick note of the surroundings - plantlife, which seemed to be mostly scrubby bushes and the odd tree;dusty , grey ground;pale light. Her HUD indicated the air was breathable. She raised her sidearm and levelled it at the other pod, which had landed on its side a good hundred metres away.

She saw the movement and dove away as bullet pinged past. She saw a puff of soil as the round hit the embankment beyond her own pod and she swore.

A survivor.

She growled, then crawled on her belly into the cover of some scrub-bush, then tried to get a bead on the pod once more. She saw movement again, but this time no shot came. Her opponent seemed to be trying to pinpoint her location.

"It' s no use!" came a quavering voice, "Surrender and well show you mercy!"

We? Were there more? Lonnie frowned and surveyed the pod - it looked big enough for a few people. Slowly, the pilot crawled a bit further forward. From this angle, she could see around the edge of the pod.

A single figure crouched there, what looked like a rifle cradled in their arms. It was a woman, young, with pastel hair. Carefully Lonnie adjusted and lined up her shot - from this distance, even with a pistol, she'd be able to wound, or kill her opponent.

The woman suddenly twitched and her eyes shifted to stare at Lonnie. The pilot cursed and fired, but her shot went wide as the pastel haired woman dropped back. At first Lonnie thought she *had* hit her; except the woman seemed to be scrambling backwards.

And then Lonnie heard the warbling trill *right behind her* .

Chapter End Notes

Wonder who that WIP was / is!!

And yes, another chapter has been added. But I realised that this one would be FAR too long and I wanted to get SOMETHING out today for all of you!

(Also, Seahawk is just indisposed. Mermista, however , IS VERY NOT HAPPY)

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

Things take a turn for the worse.

Co-operation isn't a dirty word.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It wasn't what she'd expected. Honestly, she had no idea what she *had* expected - their survey's of the system hadn't quite gotten to taking samples of local flora and fauna - most Horde surveys were just about easily mineable resources - fauna fell into the categories of "Can it be turned into rations" or "Can it be used for manual labour" - anything more was superfluous.

She was fairly sure this thing would fall into a third category of "Kill it with fire" (Preferably from orbit)

The thing stood upright and looked like some sort of bipedal fish lizard *thing*. A gaping, fanged maw sat in a face that was fringed with flared spines, which resembled fins. It's torso was an oily blue, scaled and ridged. It's hands were strange - four fingered and with *suckers*.

Lonnie gagged at the smell from its mouth as it warbled again, a strange gurgling sound, then yelped as the thing lunged at her. She managed to roll away and tried to bring her weapon to bear. The

create gurgled again and hacked up something - a purple goop splashed against the ground and began to sizzle. Lonnie swore and back-peddled, trying to get to her feet. The thing lumbered after her and reached out with its suckered hands and grappled at Lonnie's legs. She heard the sizzle of cloth and the armour of her flight suit as the thing took hold.

She yelped again as the creature hauled her closer and she raised her pistol, only to have the thing reach out and snatch it away. She gawped as the weapon began to *dissolve* and felt her heart sink as the monster tossed the now-useless weapon away. Her despair turned to sudden *agony* as her leg blossomed with pain. The creature loomed above her, drool beginning to drip from its awful face.

And then the thing's head exploded and it toppled to one side.

Lonnie jolted and looked across to where the pastel haired woman now stood, braced against the side of her escape pod. There was a steely determination in her eyes as she regarded the fallen monster. Slowly, the woman approached, rifle trained on the beast. It twitched and the woman fired - not a surprised reaction shot, but a purposeful, aimed one.

Lonnie opened her mouth to say something then groaned in pain and slumped back. She bit her lip and grunted, almost afraid to look down, worried that the thing had dissolved her foot off or something.

"No, dont fall asleep," came a worried voice. Lonnie managed to open her eyes and saw the woman was now squatting by her legs, a survival kit open nearby. The rifle was on the other side of the woman - well out of reach.

Definitely not a complete idiot.

"Wh...what are you doing?"

"Saving your leg. I think. Or trying to," muttered the woman. She was, now she was up close, a little shorter than Lonnie, curvy too. Her jumpsuit had purple patterns on it at the shoulders and her hair seemed to have some sort of glitter in it. Or was gene modded to literally *sparkle* . Her tone was absent, conversational almost and she turned a slightly sheepish smile towards Lonnie.

"Why?"

The woman looked non-plussed, "Because you're hurt?"

"...we were going to shoot each other a minute ago."

"Yeah, well...I kinda felt that shooting you now would be, bad form, or, yknow...just kinda wrong?" the woman huffed and shrugged, "Plus my husband would make pouty faces at me for *executing* someone. I do not need that."

"Wow, what a sense of..." Lonnie winced as a cold sensation ran up her leg, followed by a sense of blissful numbness, "Morality ."

"Psh. Horde and morality in the same sentence," scoffed the woman, "Oh no, they didnt pay their taxes, lets *bombard the planet from orbit!* Or, how about, *They said something mean about the emperor, let's bombard the planet from orbit!* Or my personal favourite, *Hey they just asked from trade concessions… LETS BO-"*

"Alright, woa, touchy... we dont just... AH!" groused Lonnie. She winced as the woman tightened what looked like a dressing around her leg with perhaps a *little* too much. Lonnie winced then lay back. She realised the woman had pulled her over to the wreckage of the escape pod and frowned, "Uh... we... why are we here?"

The woman gave her a look that bordered on dumbfounded. She pointed to where the corpse of the monster lay. All around it the ground smoked and bubbled, "I could have left you lying in acid buuuut didnt think you'd appreciate that. The medkit only has so much in it."

Lonnie swallowed and nodded. She looked up at the woman and exhaled, "Uh"...

"The words you are looking for are *thank you* ," the woman's smile was sickly sweet and entirely insincere, "Anyway , I assume you have a transponder going so, what now?"

Lonnie stared at the woman and then glanced at where her pod sat, several yards away. That drew a slow nod from the glittery woman. She stood and looked about to leave.

"Uh.. um.. .wait." Lonnie reached out and froze as the woman turned a hard glare on her, "Um..my uh..it' s in the ejector pod. But, uh"… she swallowed, "There might be more of those..things."

The woman frowned at her, then glanced down at the wound, "Better not make any noise then. Or get into the pod and hope for the best."

"You cant *leave* me here," exclaimed the Horde pilot, "Why bother patching me up?"

The glittery woman huffed and leaned back against the escape pod at her back. She glared at the pilot, "Three people *died* up there with your little stunt. I have no idea how many others you killed back at the station. I'd be *well* within my rights to just..leave you."

"Then why save me?" challenged Lonnie.

"Because it' s what we *do* . You weren't a threat anymore. You're a person and dammit"..the woman scrubbed a hand over her face and sighed, "And honestly that didn't look like a good way to go for *anyone* . But now"..she sighed and sat down, "I'm not leaving. But

we do need to work out what happens when *one* of our teams turns up. And you're a good intel source."

That last bit felt tacked on, but Lonnie still bristled, "Oh, so not as altruistic, huh?"

"Please. As if you wouldn't have just *run* if that had been me. Or you'd have just shot it and left me to die."

Lonnie opened her mouth, then closed it. She licked her lips and couldn't meet the woman's eyes, "I... I don't know."

Silence settled and the glittery woman let out a breath of air, "Wow."

"What?"

"Introspection. Something our biologist talks about. Don't see it much from Hordies."

Lonnie glared at her, "What's that supposed to mean?"

"Just... you guys are so fanatical. Just do-as-I-say types."

"Fuck you, you know *nothing*."

The woman snorted and shrugged, "You're a military unit who harass freighters and shoot down miners. Big scary people! Bullies," a smirk tugged at her lips, "How'd the last miner you take on turn out?"

The comment drew a sharp inhalation from Lonnie. Her eyes narrowed, "That's…"

"Everyone in the system knows you guys got *spanked*. We aren't scared of you any more. The Emperor and his stupid, cowardly bullies won't be able to get a grip here. You know that. So why bother?"

Lonnie's jaw worked, "We need *order*."

"We have order. Just not with a nasty red flag," the woman looked up at the sky with a frown, then glanced around at the surroundings, "Fun as this is, we need shelter. I think that thing was attracted by the noise of the crash. So, let's move."

"Uh, not exactly…mobile," scoffed Lonnie. The woman shrugged and pulled something out of the pod next to her. It looked like a bracing-bar from a crash harness. Lonnie watched as the woman yanked some tape from the survival kit and taped a dull piece of wreckage over the top, then reached down to haul Lonnie to her feet. She then gave the makeshift crutch to her and gestured towards a low rise.

“After you,” Lonnie scowled as the woman smiled. She glanced down at the rifle the woman bent down to retrieve, along with the survival kit. Lonnie huffed.

“Alright.” She hobbled forwards, mind racing at how she could turn the situation around.

“So, what do I call you?”

“Force-Pilot Lonnie Even, FZ144985,” she ground out mechanically.

“Cool, name, rank, number . That is all you guys are, I suppose,” mused the woman from behind her.

“You so advanced and enlightened you dont have a name then?”

“Hmmer .”

“Seriously?” Lonnie looked over her shoulder at the shorter girl and snorted, “Sounds like a bad drink at a bar .”

"My bar has no bad drinks, Hordie."

"So what's your game plan here? We just wait it out, hope our own side lands first?"

"Pretty much. Stop the local wildlife eating us. I'm not *averse* to shooting you if you try anything."

Lonnie smiled to herself. The woman hadn't even considered trashing Lonnie's transponder in the pod. That'd have been the *first* thing Lonnie would have done. Mind you, those things tended to be pretty resilient anyway, but still.

They trudged along as the sun began to set. The air temperature began to drop as they moved in towards what looked like a rocky outcropping. Grimmer nodded and looked about, "Um"…

The pause made Lonnie's smirk widen, "You have no idea what to do?"

"Cover, shelter, that sort of thing," Huf fed Grimmer. Lonnie shook her head.

"I'm gonna die because the only one who survived the crash turns out to have no field survival skills."

"Enough skills to stop your leg dropping of f," grumbled Gimmer .

"Eh, you're probably gonna shoot me in a few hours anyway . Now, we want up on those rocks - height advantage. Also, probably cover from the elements."

"And you are getting up there *how* ?"

"Guess you can carry me," smirked Lonnie.

"Nah, Ill just leave you down here as bait for the animals," snickered Gimmer . Her laugh became louder as Lonnie turned a glare on her, "Oh wow . Hordie doesnt like people playing nasty?"

"Will you cut that out. We're *keeping the peace* . Yeah we have to be...harsh. But we arent monsters."

Gimmer 's eyes went hard, "Tell that to my crew," then she waved the rifle ahead. Lonnie huffed and limped into the outcropping. They managed to find some relatively easy rocks to scramble up, which put them under an overhang, with enough shelter from the winds. After depositing the survival kit, Gimmer unrolled a pair of mats and then gestured to Lonnie.

The pilot arched an eyebrow, "What?"

"Do your soldier thing. I have *no* idea how tents work."

Lonnoe shook her head, "Civvies," and managed to hop over to set up a rudimentary windbreak. Gimmer took the opportunity to gather some plants and dried kindling to set up a small fire.

As the sun set, the pair huddled down and Gimmer fished out a pair of ration packs. She heated them in an auto-boiler from the pack, then passed one to Lonnie. The pilot grimaced as she popped the ration open and poured some of it down her throat.

"Yeesh. Seems like rations dont change anywhere."

"Yeah. Reheated grey or reheated brown? We get some knock off Horde supplies now and then. You guys really dont get variety."

"Aint that the truth," sighed Lonnie. She leaned back against the stone and her gaze drifted, "So. Uh. Thanks again."

Gimmer nodded, "ANy idea what that thing was?"

"Not a clue. Hopefully no more out there."

The glittery woman barked a laugh, "Now you're tempting fate."

They lapsed into silence and listened as the wind gently whistled through the outcropping. After a few minutes, Lonnie shifted and looked at the other woman, "So, uh.what' s the plan with watch duty?"

"W atch duty?" Gimmer blinked in surprise.

"Y eah, well, we know that there's monsters around," Lonnie cursed herself. She'd just fallen into routine, as if this woman was another Horde soldier and they were discussing shift rotation. Just because the woman had saved her life did *not* make them buddies.

Gimmer stared at her and frowned, "And I suppose you want the rifle for your watch?"

"W ould be useful, but I guess you wont fall for that."

"Like Im going to sleep with a Horde soldier nearby . Youll kill me in my sleep."

Lonnie felt suddenly affronted by that. She shifted and glared at Gimmer . True, some of her comrades would take advantage, turn the tables. Hell, *she* would if the situation was a little more

favourable. But here she was, tired, wounded and drained. Even if she got the rifle - then what? Stay awake until rescue arrived?

"Look, reality is... our options are trust *or* try to stay awake to stop the one of us backstabbing the other."

Glimmer sighed, "You make a solid point. And I hate it. But, I'm going to sleep with the rifle. You see anything, you wake me. And then we deal with it. No idea how long until rescue... if it's a while, then well see about trust"...

Lonnie grit her teeth, but just nodded. They fell into silence again and Lonnie's head began to droop. She tried to force her eyes open, but the combination of post-combat adrenaline crash, coupled with her wounds and the numbing painkiller finally dragged her into sleep.

She woke to find Glimmer slumped against the wall, just a few feet along, gently snoring. The fire had burned down a little ways and the dawn's early grey was starting to creep into the outcropping. Lonnie groaned and Glimmer snorted loudly, then jolted upright.

"Wha? I'm awa...whassat?" The pastel haired woman looked around wild eyed. Truth told, she looked frazzled. Lonnie guessed she'd probably spent most of the night awake. She snorted and shook her head.

"Shifts, dumbass. Now you're gonna be all over the place."

Gimmer grumbled, but fished around the survival kit for breakfast - some simple cracker things. They regarded one another for a while until Lonnie spoke up again, "So, your plan?"

"Wait out. Then..well, I'm not letting your people take me. Don't fancy being strapped to a torture chair for the rest of my likely-to-be-short life."

Lonnie mused and nodded, "Fair . So, go down blaze of glory? Not gonna try to ransom me for your freedom?"

"Psh, like *that* would work."

"Fair . I mean, they'd let you give me back and then just take you anyway," shrugged Lonnie.

"That is...surprisingly frank of you," retorted Gimmer with an arched eyebrow. The pilot nodded.

"Well, I ain't gonna lie to you - you know how we operate, mostly . No real negotiation, can't show weakness. Honestly , if they show up, surrender and...I'll put in a good word. My commander she'll treat you well. She ain't a complete bitch."

"Oh that's reassuring," deadpanned Gimmer, "Shell hold on the shock lances?"

"Just stick you in a cell. We're keeping the peace. Fighting pirates. How is that a *bad* thing?"

"How is harassing traders, driving people of f planets and labelling anyone who disagrees with you *pirates* a good thing?"

"Look, I'm a soldier, I follow orders. Without that, it falls apart."

"And if your superiors order you to shoot someone innocent?"

Lonnie's jaw worked and she met Gimmer's stare, "N...no such thing. Only valid targets."

"Like you dont enjoy it," sneered Gimmer. Her grip tightened on the rifle and she sagged slightly, "I dont know why I'm even bothering"...

"I just fly the ships," returned Lonnie, stoically.

"And blow up *other* ships," Gimmer glared back.

A noise drew their attention. A strange, slithering *hiss* . Dimmer groaned and looked about, trying to identify the source. Lonnie squinted, then pointed up, past the outcropping, to a raised boulder opposite their shelter.

A creature was clambering over the top - orange-red scales, with black stripes and bulbous eyes. Its skin looked smooth, however, the scales almost imperceptible. Like the other creature, it too looked almost humanoid as it clambered over the rock. As they watched, the thing's tongue emerged and tasted the air. The appendage lashed about, a good metre long, as it scented.

"Whaaaat the hell?" asked Lonnie, appalled at this *thing* . First a vomiting fish man, now a weird lizard thing?

"Yeah, *nope* ," answered Dimmer . She aimed and fired.

The reptile jinked and the round just shattered the rock. Then the creature's eyes locked onto them and it *leapt.*

The women shouted in alarm as it landed in their little camp. The tongue whipped out and coiled around Dimmer 's neck. Then it began to drag her in, jaws unhinging to an alarming degree. The rifle fell as Dimmer grappled with the slimy tongue.

And then Lonnie clubbed the thing over the head with her crutch. The creature made an open-mouthed warble and its tongue disengaged suddenly. It spun to face the wounded pilot, but Gimmer , on her knees now, pushed herself up and tackled the thing off the edge of the rock they had camped on. Lonnie scrambled over to peer down into the small passage below their camp, where Gimmer was now grappling with the stunned reptile.

"That seemed like a REALL Y bad idea," Lonnie called down.

"Uhhh yeah," groaned the glitter-girl, "I dnt, uh..think it through!"

Cursing, Lonnie limped back and saw the rifle, discarded nearby. She flopped down onto the rock and retrieved it, then belly-crawled to the edge of their camp to look down. Gimmer was starting to tire, clearly.

"Roll! Of f the thing!"

Gimmer didnt look up. She just shouted, "What?"

"T rust me! Move!"

With a shriek of frustration, Gimmer leapt clear . As she did, Lonnie awkwardly angled the rifle down and fired. The reptile, which was

moving to chase Gimmer as she rolled away, juddered and flinched as the impact burst through the side of its ribcage. Then it slumped and went still. Lonnie heaved a sigh and rolled onto her back.

A few moments later, Gimmer had climbed back up the rockface and stood at the edge of their camp. She regarded Lonnie with a set jaw. The pilot, propped up against the wall, with the rifle in her lap, regarded her right back.

"Guess we're even now," murmured Lonnie.

"Well, my leg is still mostly attached so," Gimmer responded, slowly. Lonnie nodded. Then she struggled to her feet and hopped towards Gimmer. She held the rifle out and met her gaze.

Gimmer blinked, "Uh...what's this?"

Lonnie shrugged, "A rifle, duh," then her expression changed to something else, "But mostly it's...It's trust," she shrugged, "Don't read too much into it. Just, if my people get here first...I'll put in a good word. Yours get here first...do the same. We're stuck here. We need to work together."

Gimmer nodded slowly, then moved to start packing up the camp., "Sounds...like a plan. We need to move though. Think we're attracting more things."

"Right you are," murmured the pilot.

The rest of the day and that evening followed a similar pattern - the pair moved towards a new sheltered spot, this time more of a sloping rise dotted with rocky shelters; they set up camp and made small talk. Except this time, they actually seemed to relax.

"Academy stuff f. I mean you look back on it and *wow* was a lot of it a waste of time," Lonnie chuckled as she spooned another mouthful of rations from the boil-in-a-bag, "Pressing clothes, marching. Nothing you *actually* do day to day."

"Wow, the Empire makes you do entirely pointless tasks that serve no legit purpose, who knew?" chided Gimmer. Lonnie rolled her eyes, but Gimmer pressed on, her voice thoughtful, "Honestly though, I get you. Sometimes there's paperwork and you just thing *why*? I mean, some of it's holdover stuff from Imperial methods. Trade logs, inventory in triplicate. But...hard to break habits yknow?"

"Yeah, I getcha," chuckled Lonnie.

Gimmer stared into their fire and chewed her lip, "So why'd you join?"

"No real choice. Parents died in a cargo hauler crash. I got volunteered in with all the orphans. Statutory service."

"And the end game?" Gimmer pushed.

"Whaddya mean," Lonnie frowned.

"I mean...well, we're not at *war*, but...is that it? Serve til you die?"

The question made Lonnie shift slightly. Her mind went to her friends her...well, she wasn't sure what they were. She shrugged.

"Not sure. I mean, honestly, I think I'll die in a pilot's seat. Nothing compares to flying. But...live long enough...I wouldn't say no to maybe a farm."

Gimmer chuckled, "Really? Growing spuds and stuff?"

"Maybe," murmured Lonnie, "Gotta be something *after*? I mean yeah, we're all *for the Horde* and *Corps first!* But...I think we want that bit of peace some days."

"Provided the Horde hasn't..."

"Bombed it from orbit? Yeah that joke is *old*."

Glimmer shrugged and they both fell into another silence, this one oddly more comfortable.

The following day Lonnie felt something was off. They trudged through another small pass, searching for a water source. Her leg was still aching, but she could limp on it at least, with minimal use of the crutch. She had the strangest feeling they were being watched. That feeling was only compounded when they found the corpse of another beast. It was another of the acid spewers - its chest blown out by some sort of energy blast. Lonnie looked about and frowned.

"This looks recent."

"A qualified hunter and tracker, huh?" Glimmer seemed strangely calm about it - that or she was hiding her nerves really well. The slight tremble in her weapon showed she was nervy.

It wasnt until they found the scorched camp that Lonnie began to get *really* worried.

The place looked like it had been a sort of temporary depot - crates stacked up, a temporary landing pad, tents scattered about.

It was all ash however.

Bodies lay strewn about and the smell of burnt flesh still lingered in the air. Lonnie's brow creased as she took in the empty landing pad, "Well, of course it wouldn't be that easy"…

"Who…what did this?" muttered Glimmer, "Who were these people?"

"Not friends of yours?" asked Lonnie. The glittery-girl just shook her head. Lonnie shrugged, "Pirates I assume…and, yeah, those *look* like cages. Slavers, maybe?"

"What?" Glimmer squeaked, "We…we don't *allow* ...."

"That seems to be working out so well," scoffed Lonnie. Her eyes scanned the ridges around them and she shuddered. She still had that feeling of being watched, "I think whoever did this is…still around."

The pair moved away from the destroyed camp and set up their own defensible position in a small copse of scrubby trees. It was as they were settling down for the night that they heard the shots, a distance away. But clearly some form of weapons fire. The distant squeals of

some sort of animal travelled on the wind and the two women tried to settle back down.

It was as dawn was breaking the next day that the sound of engines roused them. Lonnie sat bolt upright as her eyes locked onto the sky. She lunged and grappled the rifle from Gimmer's side, just as the glittery-girl awoke. They stared at one another for a long while, then Lonnie scrambled to her feet and levelled the rifle at Gimmer.

For a moment, they regarded one another as a Horde shuttle craft blasted overhead and did a loop around, clearly trying a search pattern. Eyes fixed on Gimmer, Lonnie stepped out of their cover and waved as the shuttle came back around. They watched as the squat craft waggled its stubby wings in response, then took another turn to head towards more level ground to land. Lonnie turned around and stared hard at Gimmer, then carefully placed the rifle on the ground.

"I trust," she said and nodded to Gimmer.

Then she turned and hobbled her way down the short slope from the copse of trees, towards the slowly descending shuttle.

The hatched opened on the side to reveal Scorpia's relieved face, "Oh my *gosh* Lonnie! Oh WOW! We were worried we'd have to do a whole scan of the planet and well."

"Hey , good to see you too Commander. The Captain not want to make a personal de-"

"Get in the fuckin' shuttle Lonnie," groused a voice from inside, and Catra leaned out with a hand extended, "Destroyer 's in orbit. We pulled out all the stops for your sorry ass."

Lonnie smirked, then looked back briefly. Catra frowned and tried to follow her gaze, but Lonnie snapped back to stare at her . Scorpia just smiled, "So, um..woa, wait, what happened to your leg?"

"Wounded fighting some of the wildlife..got patched up."

"Looks like you had help, Force-pilot," mused Catra, "Plus you smell..weird."

Lonnie shrugged, "A survivor from the crash."

"A revel?" Catra' s eyes narrowed, "Where are they now?"

"They..Didn't make it. This place is just..full of nasties. Can..can we go?"

Catra stared at her, then nodded, “Alright. Come on. Pilot, get us the fuck outta here.”

As Lonnie climbed onto the shuttle, she risked another glance back. She couldn't make out Glimmer in the copse. But her eyes did catch a glint of something on the ridge line beyond. The glint of light off of metal. Her eyes widened for a moment and she swore she saw what looked like a figure slowly stand as the shuttle began to take off. But then she was distracted as the medic on board began to fuss over her wound, complimenting the treatment and she just slumped back. She looked over at Scorpia and Catra.

“So...did we win?”

Glimmer watched the shuttle depart with a strange mixture of shock and melancholy. Lonnie’s behaviour was weird - not what she’d expected at all. Hell, the woman had even left the rifle behind!

A sound made her spin, her heart in her throat. A figure stepped through the copse and paused to regard her.

Glimmer. “Keeping good company as usual,” smirked the blonde in front of her.

“Adora?”

“Y ep,” the blonde popped the p and Glimmer glowered at her .

“How long have you been here?”

“Oh only a half day . Been tracking you and your new bestie. I was going to take her out but you seemed to have a game plan so… didnt want to interfere.”

“There was no game plan! W e were *surviving* ! What did you do?”..

“Uh..killed the pirates?” explained Adora, slowly , “And the excess critters that had your scent. Honestly, I was a bit far off. I could have sniped her but then what? Y ou’d have had a corpse and I couldnt get close in time to explain. Y ou’d have been spooked. So, yeah. THis is as close as I managed to get.”

Glimmer nodded then sighed and looked up into the sky . She frowned, “So. That was weird.”

“Y eah. Kinda glad I *didn’t* shoot her,” mused Adora. But her face had another pensive look as her hands fiddled with the sleeve of her brown leather jacket.

Glimmer grimaced and sighed, “They dont seem all bad.”

Adora shook her head, "Most aren't," she said quietly, "Most… Aren't."

"So," Glimmer managed, after a pause. She winced and looked at Adora, "Did we win?"

Adora glanced at her and shrugged, "Well… we didn't *lose*."

They both stared up at the dot of the shuttle and contemplated the words. When your enemy had a face, a name, *feelings*? When they became relatable, *human*? Was any victory a win? Was it easier?

Glimmer sighed, "Just… I want to head home Adora. Can we go home?"

The blonde nodded, slowly, a sadness in her eyes. The view through the rifle scope still in her mind as she'd seen that face from the past, only a few hundred yards away. She could've ended it with a single pull of the trigger. But she hadn't. *Couldn't.*

She was still the most beautiful thing she'd ever seen.

Adora sighed, "Yeah Glimmer. Let's… Lets get you home."

Chapter End Notes

And so ends another vignette!

It's meant to be a little messy and awkward. To be honest, this one COULD have gotten longer, more in depth, but it'd risk stealing ideas from OTHER aspects of this AU I want to show you guys.

Anyway, let me know what you think! Not as tidy as my other stuff BUT I wanted this one done so I can focus in 100% on Grace and Favour.

End Notes

YEP! Im getting back in the saddle. I think Im nervy about finishing 2/3 of my projects. Plus having moved and a few other family things ongoing, its knocked my writing a tad.

As ever, let me know your thoughts! And if you want, follow me on twitter: @jjash

Its a weird mix of politics and she ra stuf f (plus other geekery) - I do need to curate my stuff a bit more I think!

Anyway, I hope to increase my writing tempo a bit this week - we shall see!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!